



English — Cbse English — Combined Half-Yearly (40 Marks)

Subject: English | Class: Class 9

Total Marks: 40 | Time Allowed: 1h 30m | CBSE

General Instructions:

1. The paper has four sections: A (Reading), B (Writing), C (Grammar), D (Literature).
2. Sections A-C assess language skills; Section D assesses the prescribed textbook.
3. Attempt all sections. Internal choice is provided in the Writing section.

Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
Section A — Reading Attempt all 1 questions. Each carries 10 mark(s).		



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
1	<i>Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.</i> India's Rainfall by the Numbers India's economy and ecology are deeply tied to the monsoon, which delivers roughly 75 percent of the country's annual rainfall between June and September. According to the India Meteorological Department (IMD), the Long Period Average (LPA) of the southwest monsoon, based on data from 1971 to 2020, stands at 88 centimetres. Any figure between 96 and 104 percent of this benchmark is classified as "normal." The monsoon, however, is anything but uniform. In 2019, the country recorded 110 percent of the LPA, making it the wettest season in a quarter century. By contrast, the 2023 monsoon settled at 94 percent of the LPA, officially categorised as below normal. Such year-to-year swings directly affect reservoir levels, irrigation, and crop sowing. Regional disparities are equally striking. Mawsynram in Meghalaya, often called the wettest place on Earth, receives an annual average of about 11,871 millimetres, while parts of western Rajasthan struggle with less than 200 millimetres. This vast gap shapes everything from cropping patterns to drinking-water security. Climate scientists warn that rising global temperatures are intensifying these extremes. A 2020 report by the Ministry of Earth Sciences noted that extreme rainfall events over central India have risen sharply since 1950, even as the total number of rainy days has declined. In other words, it is raining less often but harder when it does. Sustainable water management — rainwater harvesting, groundwater recharge, and efficient irrigation — is therefore no longer optional. With over half of India's cultivated land still rain-fed, every millimetre of monsoon rainfall carries an economic weight that the nation can ill afford to waste. (i) According to the passage, what share of India's annual rainfall does the southwest monsoon deliver? [2 mark(s)] (A) 75 percent (B) 88 percent (C) 94 percent (D) 110 percent (ii) What can be inferred from the passage about the trend in rainfall patterns over central India since 1950? [2 mark(s)] (A) Rainy days have increased while the intensity of each event has decreased. (B) Both the number of rainy days and the intensity of downpours have risen equally. (C) Fewer rainy days now bring heavier downpours than they did in the past. (D) The total number of rainy days has remained unchanged despite rising temperatures. (iii) The word "striking" in the sentence "Regional disparities are equally striking" most nearly means: [2 mark(s)]	10



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	(A) harmful (B) remarkable (C) unexpected (D) minor (iv) Why does the passage describe sustainable water management as "no longer optional" rather than merely "important"? [2 mark(s)] (v) What is the central concern of the passage regarding India's monsoon? [2 mark(s)]	
Section B — Writing Attempt 1 out of 1.		
2	Informal Letter You are Vivaan/Vanya, a Class 9 student living at 18, Saffron Street, Pune. Your grandparents, who live in Nagpur, sent you a Kindle e-reader as a birthday gift. Write a letter to them thanking them for the gift and sharing some exciting news about a recent achievement at school. In your letter you may touch upon: • how much you love the gift and how you are using it • the exciting news you want to share (e.g., a competition result) • your plans to visit them during the holidays Word limit: 100–150 words. <i>(Word limit: 100–150 words; Suggested time: 20 min)</i> OR Paragraph Write a paragraph in 90–130 words on My Favourite Festival. You may use the following cues: • Name the festival and mention when it is usually celebrated. • Describe how you and your family celebrate it. • Explain why it is your favourite and what feeling or memory it brings to you. <i>(Word limit: 90–130 words; Suggested time: 20 min)</i>	5
Section C — Grammar Attempt all 5 questions. Each carries 1 mark(s).		
3	Identify the incorrectly used word: 'The stationery vehicle [Vocabulary — Homophones] (A) remained (B) motionless (C) traffic (D) stationery	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
4	The principal addressed the assembly ____ the entire teaching staff, expressing gratitude for their dedication throughout the academic year. [Prepositions] (A) in front of (B) in spite of (C) on account of (D) on behalf of	1
5	The government has launched a nationwide campaign to promote digital literacy among schoolchildren. Identify the type of the sentence given above. [Sentences — Types] (A) Assertive (B) Interrogative (C) Imperative (D) Exclamatory	1
6	____ attempts were made to rescue the trapped miners before the operation finally succeeded. [Adjectives (Describing Words)] (A) Numerous (B) Much (C) Little (D) Enough	1
7	How swiftly the river flows! [Sentence Transformation] (A) The river flows swiftly. (B) The river is flowing swiftly. (C) The river flows very swiftly. (D) The river flowed very swiftly.	1
Section D — Literature Attempt all 10 questions. Each carries 2 mark(s).		
8	Choose whether the given statements display: fact-opinion or cause-effect. (i) I was diagnosed with a tumour in my spine. (ii) I had a surgery and was told that I would be bound to a wheelchair for the rest of my life. <i>[Ch 9: The World of Limitless Possibilities]</i>	2
9	What are the means for people to stay connected? <i>[Ch 13: Carrier of Words]</i>	2
10	Which words are repeated in the poem? Why does the poet use repetition? <i>[Ch 14: Words]</i>	2
11	What does the electrician 'humming' while getting ready for work suggest? <i>[Ch 4: Gifts of Grace: Honouring Our Vocations]</i>	2



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
12	Why does the poet compare music to a 'needed friend'? <i>[Ch 12: A Friend Found in Music]</i>	2
13	What is the purpose of likening the mother's gaze to the sky? <i>[Ch 8: I Cannot Remember My Mother]</i>	2
14	Which language(s) do your grandparents or elderly relatives speak? <i>[Ch 1: How I Taught My Grandmother to Read]</i>	2
15	The poet uses imagery (descriptive language to create vivid mental pictures that appeal to the senses). Give any two examples from the poem. <i>[Ch 2: Bharat Our Land]</i>	2
16	The phrase 'standing ovation' is an example of an adjective-noun collocation. Identify two other similar examples from the poem. <i>[Ch 10: Nine Gold Medals]</i>	2
17	Do you think Shruti will gather the courage to speak to her father? Give a reason. <i>[Ch 11: Twin Melodies]</i>	2

